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# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp ★★★★★ MONDAY, OCTOBER 26, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 99 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00


Last week: **DJIA** 52215.16 ▲ 212.75 0.41% **NASDAQ** 25955.34 ▼ 0.7% **STOXX 600** 635.77 ▼ 1.4% **10-YR. TREASURY** ▲ 27/32, yield 4.987% **OIL** $103.27 ▲ $4.25 **EURO** $1.1204 **YEN** 156.86

## What's News

### *Business & Finance*

◆ **The current corporate** earnings boom is heavily reliant on just a handful of stocks, magnifying the risk to portfolios should the headlong growth falter. **A1**

◆ **The FBI is considering** adding an economic espionage charge against Abdulrahman Alfozan, who allegedly placed an eavesdropping device in an OpenAI conference room. **B1**

◆ **"Clayface," distributed** by Warner Bros., led the domestic film box office, pulling in $24 million on its opening weekend. **B2**

◆ **American executives** quit Polar LNG after learning the energy startup was secretly being funded by Russian natural-gas concern Novatek. **B3**

◆ **Options in Trade Desk** edged into the money after the advertising tech company's CEO repriced contracts for himself, senior executives and more than 2,000 employees. **B1**

◆ **Bombardier plans** to invest $270 million to expand its U.S. infrastructure presence and make 800 domestic hires, stepping up operations in at least four states. **B4**

◆ **Booz Allen expects** growth to accelerate in its second half, driven by continued demand for national-security technologies and easing pressure in its civil business. **B4**

◆ **Archer Aviation plans** to launch air-taxi networks in three Texas cities, deploying electric VTOL aircraft in Austin, Houston and the Dallas-Fort Worth area. **B4**

◆ **Gucci's sales slide** raised further doubts about Kering's ability to recover, driving the parent's shares down nearly 17% in Paris on Friday. **B3**

### *Worldwide*

◆ **Brazil's Lula da Silva** won an upset re-election victory in the presidential race over Flávio Bolsonaro, giving the leftist stalwart an unprecedented fourth term. **A4**

◆ **Venezuelan opposition** leader María Corina Machado returned home after nearly 11 months in exile, putting new pressure on the U.S.-backed interim government. **A7**

◆ **U.S. intelligence** suggested that Iranian preparations to attack Americans in the Middle East were well advanced, prompting a sudden exodus of American personnel across the region. **A6**

◆ **Serbia's longtime** strongman leader conceded defeat in elections to a student-led movement that opposes his right-wing party. **A10**

◆ **Attorney General** Blanche offered a combative defense of the government's lawsuit seeking to block certification of Alaska's Senate race if the GOP candidate loses. **A4**

◆ **Some 67,000** expatriate Israelis were expected to return to Israel to vote in Tuesday's general election, the first since the Hamas-led Oct. 7 attacks. **A6**

◆ **France's Marine Le Pen** kicked off her 2027 presidential campaign by casting herself as a unifying figure after weeks of unrest. **A8**

◆ **Six Flags said it** plans to add seat belts to some of its roller coasters following a deadly incident this month at its Georgia theme park. **A3**

◆ **North Korean** leader Kim Jong Un made a surprise trip to China, crossing a new bridge at the border. **A7**


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MIGUEL SCHINCARIOL/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Brazil's leftist president, Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, center, celebrates Sunday after defeating Flávio Bolsonaro for a fourth term.

# Lula Clings to Power in Brazil Presidential Election Surprise

By Samantha Pearson

SÃO PAULO—President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva clung to power in Sunday's presidential election by orchestrating a surprise victory over Flávio Bolsonaro, winning an unprecedented fourth term and cementing his place as one of the world's longest-serving democratically elected leaders.

The leftist leader, just two days away from turning 81, won 51.8% of the vote against 48.2% for Bolsonaro, electoral authorities said with over 99% of the votes counted. The victory came after da Silva's Workers' Party requested that voting be extended Sunday, after reports that some local governments had reduced the number of buses serving poorer voters, who tend to support the president.

That request was granted by Supreme Court Justice Cristiano Zanin—a decision that came a minute after voting was supposed to end, prompting chaos at some polling stations. While Bolsonaro's camp also requested an extension to voting in some parts of the country, the move by Zanin, who served as da Silva's personal defense lawyer during the Car Wash corruption scandal that entangled the leftist, drew fierce criticism of bias. Bolsonaro called Zanin's intervention "unacceptable" and refused to recognize the election result, vowing to seek its annulment.

Da Silva became the first presidential candidate in Brazil's modern democratic history to lose the first round of voting but win the runoff. His adversary was the eldest son of Jair Bolsonaro, a bitter rival who served as president and was convicted of trying to overturn da Silva's 2022 victory.

Cheers erupted from apartment windows and car horns blared across São Paulo after a frantic last-minute push by musicians, celebrities and campaigners to mobilize first-round abstainers and secure da Silva's victory. Despite widespread apathy at the start of the campaign, Sunday's 19% abstention rate was one of the lowest on record—and essential in delivering victory to the president.

"I want to thank the Brazilian people for the generosity they have shown me for such a long time," da Silva said late Sunday, his voice so hoarse he could barely speak. He dedicated his victory to elderly vot-

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◆ **Venezuelan opposition head returns, pressuring U.S.....A7**

# Just a Few AI Giants Power Corporate Earnings

Nvidia and Micron account for 34% of growth in expected S&P 500 profits

By Hannah Erin Lang

Wall Street has rested much of its optimism about the stock market on a surge in corporate earnings. The catch is that the profit growth is being driven by a handful of AI giants.

Analysts expect companies in the S&P 500 to report a 30% jump in third-quarter earnings from a year ago, according to FactSet, boosting investor confidence that the good times can keep rolling so long as businesses keep printing money. But just two companies—Nvidia and Micron—account for 34% of that growth, according to a Dow Jones Market Data analysis.

And only 10 companies—including Broadcom and Meta Platforms—account for roughly two-thirds of the profit growth. Others include oil-and-gas giants that benefited from higher energy prices caused by the conflict in Iran.

It is another way the U.S. stock market has come to depend on a handful of companies tied to the artificial-intelligence trade—and the fervid race to build the infrastructure that supports the technology, as costly as it may become.

The risk posed by that concentrated earnings growth, analysts said, is the same one underpinning the broader AI

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# MAHA-MAGA Ties Are Fraying As Midterms Near

By Liz Essley Whyte And Eliza Collins

FORT WORTH, Texas—Leaders of the Make America Healthy Again movement had aimed to cement their alliance with the Make America Great Again movement, promising to spend $100 million to boost Republican candidates in the midterm elections.

But at a recent MAHA event at the Willard Hotel in Washington, that message didn't seem to have gotten through to Mark Gorton, who gave more than $1 million to support Robert F. Kennedy Jr. presidential bid in 2024 and is listed on the MAHA PAC's website as co-president.

"It's not an important election," he said when asked why he hadn't donated recently to the MAHA effort to support Republicans in the midterms. "I don't actually really like being involved in politics."

The MAHA-MAGA marriage is tenuous—and one reason is the frailty of Kennedy's political apparatus. Most of the donors who gave last cycle to

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◆ **How the Supreme Court shapes midterms..... A4**

# As AOC's Ambition Grows, Her Tactics Are Softening

Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez's inclusive approach has risks

*By **Eliza Collins, Maya Davis** and **Sabrina Rodriguez***

Days after Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez became the youngest woman elected to Congress, the New York City bartender and Democratic socialist was in Washington praising hundreds of climate activists staging a sit-in at Rep. Nancy Pelosi's office.

"I just want to let you all know how proud I am of each and every single one of you," Ocasio-Cortez told protesters. She echoed demands that House Democrats move further to the left on climate policy, a high-profile challenge to Pelosi, a fellow Democrat and the powerful party leader.

In the eight years since, Ocasio-Cortez has been the one to shift tactics—in ways that would have once seemed unthinkable for the firebrand leftist. The result is a political transformation reflecting real-world lessons about how to win in Washington.

The 37-year-old lawmaker has tempered her combative style, cozied up to establishment Democrats and distanced herself from some extreme positions pushed by other Democratic socialists—such as abolishing prisons and the police.

Whether or not Ocasio-Cortez decides to run for president in 2028—a much-talked-about possibility she says she is considering—she has tried to broaden the progressive base to include voters whose views don't traditionally align with the far left, including Black voters and segments of MAHA.

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## *Want to Voice Boston's Airport? Lay It on Thick With the Accent*

* * *

You don't have to be wicked smaht to apply.
But don't you dare call it Beantown.

By Victoria Albert

Boston's best accent? Turns out, it's wicked hahd to find.

Just ask Logan International Airport. It launched a contest last month, looking for someone with a "voice that feels like home" to greet and guide the roughly 130,000 people who fly in and out of the airport every day.



*Talk of the townies*

More than 5,000 hopefuls lined up—at the airport's Terminal A for live auditions and in submissions online—to show off their best "lobstahs" and "hahbahs."

For some, it was a chance at redemption after years of weathering jokes about their accents. Others wanted to prove that Bostonians could, in fact, be welcoming.

Amy O'Hara, a retired police captain, said she's constantly being asked to recite Boston-inflected words "like I'm a seal at the aquarium." This was her shot at winning the ultimate seal of approval.

"I lived with the blizzard of '78 here. I was here watching when we broke the Curse of the Bambino," the 60-year-old said. "It's just part of who I am—and obviously it would be the best bragging rights ever."

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## INSIDE



**U.S. NEWS**
Older grandparents can offer more hours, and money, in a shorter horizon. **A3**



MIKE BLAKE/REUTERS

**BUSINESS & FINANCE**
Shoppers are spooked that AI is driving up prices for some products. **B1**

# Card Issuers Take Aim At Points Hoarders

By Ben Glickman And Oyin Adedoyin

Jared Friedman discovered a way to get free credit-card points earlier this year and decided to share it with his followers on TikTok and Instagram.

After a website offering Chase Sapphire cardholders early access to World Cup tickets crashed for certain users, the bank was offering to compensate customers with 5,000 courtesy points. In his video, Friedman flagged a key detail: Chase wasn't necessarily checking whether cardholders actually tried to buy tickets.

Not long after, he said, Chase canceled two of his credit cards citing points abuse.

"I was very frustrated," said Friedman, a 33-year-old New York City resident who posts about rewards and travel to his more than 200,000 followers.

So goes the dance between a growing universe of points junkies who are constantly on the hunt for ways to milk rewards programs, and the banks that patrol for their ever-evolving tactics.

The popularity of rewards programs has created a subculture of people obsessed with maximizing their benefits, with cardholders now keeping spreadsheets and setting up calendar reminders to ensure they don't miss out on perks. Banks say some of that behavior crosses the line and violates their rules, forcing them to crack down on so-called gamers who find ways to vacuum up points, sometimes with no intention of using their cards.

Citi earlier this year imple-

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